you want more money say so, but remember that you are an Afghan and a Muslim and that the Shah is now a servant of the Kafir infidels'.[66] In case the call to blood and faith was not enough, Dost Mohammad had been careful to ensure the chiefs' loyalty by taking hostages from all the leading maliks, and these he carefully kept at his side in Kabul.

It did not help that Prince Timur was far from a charismatic figure. The nervous and ineffectual Crown Prince was meant to act as a lure for the Khyber chiefs. But Timur was not a natural leader – his portrait shows him to be a slight and anxious-looking man – and his stumbling performance at the durbar Wade had laid on to introduce him to Peshawar did not bode well. 'On entering the Durbar tent,' wrote one observer, 'we found the poor Shahzada, unaccustomed to the royal part he was henceforth to play, standing to do the honours . . . On a motion from the Colonel [Wade] he instantly rectified it by popping with much alacrity on his gadi or throne.' But he soon lost interest, sitting 'with a listless indifference to his situation and an unyielding apathy to everything around him . . . Only recently drawn from comparative obscurity, and unaccustomed to the gaze of strangers, he seemed ill at ease with this public exhibition of his greatness, and was clearly glad when the ceremony was concluded.'[67]

Nor was there any sign as yet of the Sikh forces Ranjit Singh had promised for the invasion. For the previous two months it had been clear that once Lord Auckland had disappeared back to Simla, the wily Maharajah was doing all he could to drag his feet rather than provide the troops or supplies he had pledged. On 19 March 1839, Wade wrote to the Maharajah regretting 'that the appointment of the Muslim army and a Muslim Commander has not yet been made', and asking him 'to give immediate attention to the matter'.[68] Two days later he wrote again to point out that it was now four months since the Army of the Indus had left Ferozepur and only the household troops of two of Ranjit Singh's nobles had so far reported for duty.[69]

A stream of other complaints followed as spring turned to high summer: Sikh officials on the Indus at Attock were not co-operating in getting Prince Timur's forces ferried across; other officials were failing to provide soldiers, shelter, fodder or food supplies; troops had still not arrived – 'the services of Muslim soldiers are urgently required', wrote Wade, again and again. A month later he complained that 'the army appointed at Peshawar was in great trouble as the salaries of the soldiers have not been paid . . . the